

Mahatma Gandhi

South Africa years, every satyagraha and movement, titles and nicknames, books, and the assassination

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Why this chapter matters: Gandhi questions span 55 years of dates — South Africa, every satyagraha, every book, every title given to him by someone else. SSC loves testing the exact date of each movement and who-said-what-about-Gandhi. This chapter organises his life as one continuous timeline so the dates finally stick together instead of floating separately.

1 South Africa Years (1893–1914) 🔥

Year	Event
1888	Left for London to study law
1893	First went to South Africa
1894	Established the Natal Congress
1899	Served in an ambulance corps during the Boer War — where he adopted the principle of " Seva Dharma " (service is my religion)
1904	Established the Phoenix Settlement
1906	First used Satyagraha as a method of resistance
1908	Jailed for the first time, as a result of the 1906 Satyagraha
1915	Returned to India — 9 January , now celebrated as Pravasi Bharatiya Divas

21 years in South Africa: Gandhi spent a total of **21 years** there (1893–1914) before returning to India. **Gopal Krishna Gokhale** — Gandhi's "political guru" — travelled to South Africa to meet him during this period.

Gandhi disembarked in India at **Bombay, at Apollo Bunder**, upon his return. In **1915**, the British awarded him the title "**Kaiser-i-Hind**", in recognition of his help recruiting Indians for the First World War.

2 First Steps in India (1915–1917)

- Gave his **first public speech in India** at the **opening of Banaras Hindu University (BHU), 1916** — alongside Annie Besant and Madan Mohan Malaviya.
- First participated in a Congress session in 1901, Calcutta**, headed by **Dinshaw Edulji Wacha**.
- Met **Rabindranath Tagore** at **Shantiniketan in 1915** — Tagore gave him the title "**Mahatma**" around this time (it became widely popular by **1917**); Gandhi, in turn, gave Tagore the title "**Gurudev**".

3 Champaran, Kheda & Ahmedabad — Gandhi's First Movements in India 🔥

CORRECT CHRONOLOGICAL ORDER

Champaran (1917) → Ahmedabad Mill Strike (1918) → Kheda Satyagraha (1918) — note that within 1918, Ahmedabad came before Kheda month-wise; Champaran cannot come after either, since it happened in 1917, a full year earlier.

Movement	Year	Details
Champaran Satyagraha	1917	Gandhi's first movement in India . Fought forced indigo cultivation in Bihar under the Tinkathia System (3 out of every 20 parts of land had to grow indigo). He was informed and invited by Rajkumar Shukla , whom he had met at the 1916 Lucknow Congress session .
Ahmedabad Mill Strike	1918	Gandhi's first hunger strike , in support of mill workers demanding a wage increase

Movement	Year	Details
Kheda Satyagraha	1918	A no-tax campaign for Gujarat's farmers, hit by crop failure and famine

PYQ: Who informed Gandhi about the plight of Champaran's indigo farmers? **Ans: Rajkumar Shukla**

4 Non-Cooperation Movement (1920–1922) 🔥

Started in **August 1920** and withdrawn on **12 February 1922**, following the **Chauri Chaura incident** (4–5 February 1922, Uttar Pradesh) — a mob set fire to a police station, killing several policemen, an act of violence that led Gandhi to call off the movement entirely.

5 Civil Disobedience Movement & the Dandi March 🔥

The **Dandi March** (also called the Salt March) ran from **12 March to 6 April 1930**, starting at **Sabarmati Ashram** and ending at Dandi, where Gandhi broke the salt law. He began with about 70–78 followers; by the march's end, the number had swelled to over **50,000**. This march launched the **Civil Disobedience Movement**.

Subhas Chandra Bose's comparison: Bose compared the Dandi March to **Napoleon's journey from Paris to Elba** — a memorable analogy question.

Gandhi was named *Time* magazine's **Person of the Year for 1930** (published in the January 1931 issue) directly because of the fame the Dandi March brought him.

6 The Gandhi-Irwin Pact (5 March 1931)

Gandhi's demands	Irwin's demands
Release all political prisoners	End the Civil Disobedience Movement
Return confiscated lands	Join the Second Round Table Conference

Gandhi attended the **Second Round Table Conference (1931)** as the sole Congress representative — where he had a well-known dispute with **Dr. B.R. Ambedkar** over separate electorates for the depressed classes.

7 Yerwada Jail, the Poona Pact & Harijan Sevak Sangh

Gandhi referred to **Yerwada Jail** (Pune) — not Tihar — as a **"temple"**. It was here, in **1932**, that the **Yerwada Pact (also called the Poona Pact)** was signed with **Dr. B.R. Ambedkar**, granting the depressed classes (Dalits) separate reserved seats — India's first form of reservation. Soon after, in **1932**, Gandhi founded the **All India Harijan Sevak Sangh**.

8 Quit India Movement (1942) & "Do or Die"

The **Quit India Movement** was launched in **1942**. Gandhi gave the famous slogan **"Do or Die"** during this movement.

The Cripps Mission (1942): Sent by Churchill's government, headed by Stafford Cripps (with members Alexander and Pethick-Lawrence). Gandhi famously dismissed it as **"a post-dated cheque"**; Nehru extended the metaphor, calling it **"a post-dated cheque on a crashing bank"**. Gandhi had earlier also rejected the **August Offer (1940)**.

9 Individual Satyagraha (1940–41)

Gandhi launched the **Individual Satyagraha** in **1940–41**, but it eventually lost momentum. The **first satyagrahi** chosen was **Vinoba Bhave**; the **second** was **Jawaharlal Nehru**.

10 Movements Gandhi Was NOT Associated With

A common trick MCQ asks which movement is **not** linked to Gandhi. The **Swadeshi Movement (1905)** is the answer — Gandhi was still in South Africa at the time and had no role in it.

11 Assassination & Tributes

- Assassinated on **30 January 1948** by **Nathuram Godse**, who fired **three rounds**.
- His last words were **"He Ram"**.
- Jawaharlal Nehru** said, on Gandhi's death, **"The light has gone out of our lives."**
- Subhas Chandra Bose** gave Gandhi the title **"Father of the Nation"** in **1944**, while offering condolences after the death of Gandhi's wife, Kasturba, and referencing the earlier loss of Gandhi's son.

12 Titles & Nicknames — Who Gave Them

Title	Given by
"Mahatma"	Rabindranath Tagore (1915, popularised by 1917)
"Father of the Nation"	Subhas Chandra Bose (1944)
"Kaiser-i-Hind"	The British Government (1915)
"One-Man Boundary Force"	Lord Mountbatten
"Half-Naked Fakir"	Winston Churchill
"American Gandhi"	A title applied to Martin Luther King Jr. (both being pioneers of non-violent civil resistance)

What his wife called him: Kasturba Gandhi affectionately called him **"Manilal's papa"** or **"Devdas's papa"** — after their sons' names.

PYQ: Who gave Gandhi the title "Father of the Nation"? **Ans:** **Subhas Chandra Bose**

13 Books By and About Gandhi

Book	Author	Note
<i>Hind Swaraj</i>	Mahatma Gandhi	Written in 1909
<i>India of My Dreams</i>	Mahatma Gandhi	Not to be confused with Subhas Chandra Bose's separate work on Indian youth's vision of India
<i>My Experiments with Truth</i>	Mahatma Gandhi (original), translated by Mahadev Desai	Originally written in Gujarati , 1928; later translated into English
<i>The Life of Mahatma Gandhi</i>	Louis Fischer	—
<i>Gandhi on Non-Violence</i>	Thomas Merton	A compilation of Gandhi's writings on non-violence
<i>Being Gandhi</i>	Paro Anand	—

Gandhi's newspapers: **Indian Opinion** (published in South Africa); **Young India** and **Harijan** (both published in India).

14 Influences on Gandhi

Gandhi's thinking was most heavily shaped by **Leo Tolstoy's** writings on non-violence ("ahimsa parmo dharma") — not Karl Marx (a committed communist who advocated centralised state power along Soviet lines) and not John Ruskin, though Ruskin's *Unto This Last* is also commonly cited as an influence in broader accounts.

Khadi as a symbol: Gandhi himself considered **khadi to be a symbol of economic independence**. In **1921**, he took a vow to wear only homespun cloth, shaved his head, and adopted the dhoti as his standard dress — the **Charkha Sangh** (spinning-wheel organisation) followed in **1925**, after the **Khadi Board** was set up in **1923**.

15 Miscellaneous "Firsts" & Records

- Thrown off a train at **Pietermaritzburg** railway station, South Africa — the incident often cited as radicalising him politically.
- Presided over the **All India Khilafat Committee session in Delhi, November 1919**.
- The **first person to receive the Bharat Ratna posthumously** was **Lal Bahadur Shastri (1966)** — **not** Gandhi, who in fact never received the Bharat Ratna at all.

PYQ: Who was the first person to receive the Bharat Ratna posthumously? **Ans: Lal Bahadur Shastri, 1966**

16 Famous Slogans — Who Said What 🔥

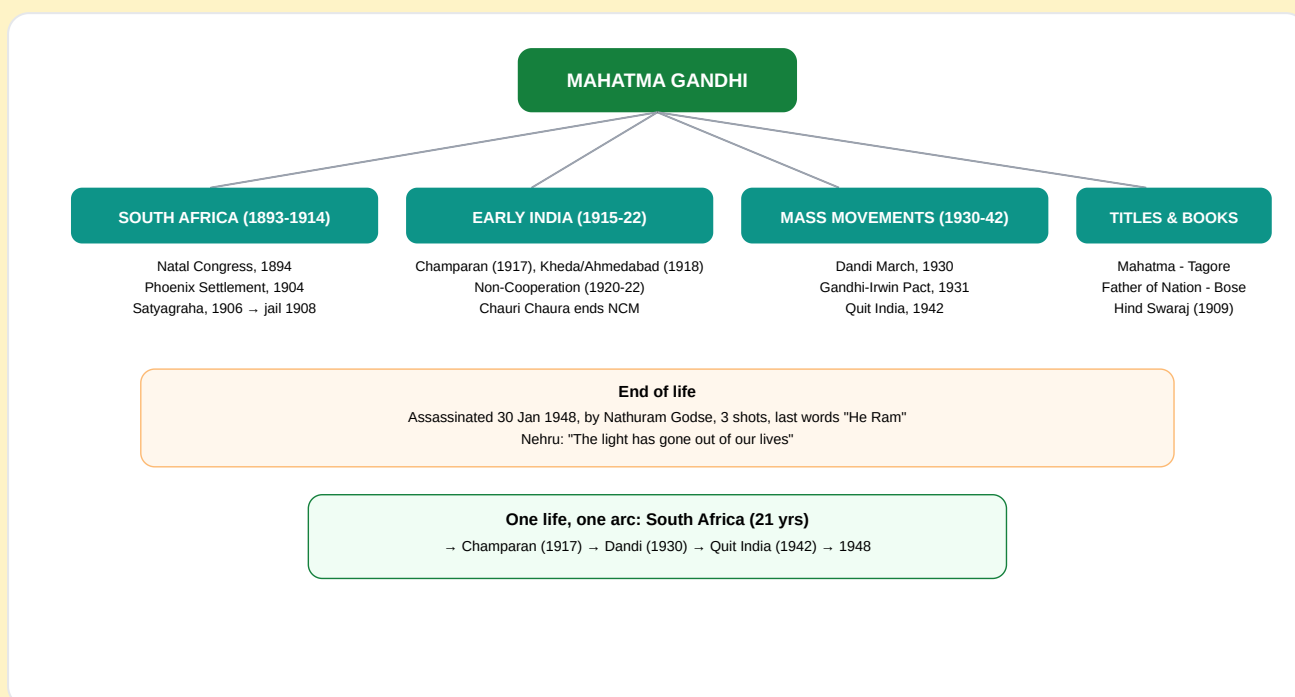
Slogan	Given by
"Do or Die" / Quit India	Mahatma Gandhi (1942)
"He Ram"	Gandhi's last words (1948)
"Jai Hind"	Subhas Chandra Bose
"Give me blood, and I will give you freedom"	Subhas Chandra Bose
"Delhi Chalo"	Subhas Chandra Bose
"Simon, Go Back"	Lala Lajpat Rai
"Who lives if India dies?"	Jawaharlal Nehru
"Back to the Vedas"	Dayananda Saraswati
"No More Tax" (Bardoli)	Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel
"Maro Firangi Ko"	Mangal Pandey
"Vande Mataram"	Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay
"Sarfaroshi ki tamanna..."	Ram Prasad Bismil
"Jana Gana Mana"	Rabindranath Tagore
"Saare Jahan Se Achha"	Muhammad Iqbal
"Swaraj is my birthright"	Bal Gangadhar Tilak (1916, Lucknow)
"Inquilab Zindabad"	Bhagat Singh
"Jai Jawan, Jai Kisan"	Lal Bahadur Shastri
"Jai Jagat"	Vinoba Bhave
"Sampoorna Kranti" (Total Revolution)	Jayaprakash Narayan
"Vijayi Vishwa Tiranga Pyara"	Shyama Prasad Mukherjee
"Every blow of the lathi... will shake the foundations of British rule"	Lala Lajpat Rai

17 Master Reference Table

Superlative / Record	Answer
Went to London to study law	1888
First went to South Africa	1893
Established Natal Congress	1894

Superlative / Record	Answer
Established Phoenix Settlement	1904
First Satyagraha (South Africa)	1906
First jailed	1908
Returned to India	9 January 1915
First public speech in India	1916, BHU opening
First movement in India	Champaran, 1917
First hunger strike	Ahmedabad Mill Strike, 1918
Non-Cooperation Movement	Aug 1920 – 12 Feb 1922
Dandi March	12 Mar – 6 Apr 1930
Gandhi-Irwin Pact	5 March 1931
Poona/Yerwada Pact	1932, with B.R. Ambedkar
Quit India Movement	1942
Assassinated	30 January 1948, by Nathuram Godse

18 Mind Map — Mahatma Gandhi



19 30-Second Revision

Fact	Value
South Africa years	1893–1914, 21 years
First movement in India	Champaran, 1917
Non-Cooperation withdrawn	12 Feb 1922, after Chauri Chaura
Dandi March	12 Mar – 6 Apr 1930
Gandhi-Irwin Pact	5 March 1931
"Mahatma" given by	Rabindranath Tagore
"Father of the Nation" given by	Subhas Chandra Bose, 1944

Fact	Value
Assassinated	30 Jan 1948, Nathuram Godse

20 PYQs from the Video (with Answers)

1. In which year did Gandhi launch his first movement in India?

Ans: 1917 (Champaran)

2. Who informed Gandhi and invited him to Champaran?

Ans: Rajkumar Shukla

3. Where did Gandhi and Rajkumar Shukla first meet?

Ans: Lucknow, at the 1916 Congress session

4. When did Gandhi start the Dandi March?

Ans: 12 March 1930

5. Which movement began with the Dandi March?

Ans: Civil Disobedience Movement

6. When was the Gandhi-Irwin Pact signed?

Ans: 5 March 1931

7. When did Gandhi return to India from South Africa?

Ans: 9 January 1915

8. Who is known as the "American Gandhi"?

Ans: Martin Luther King Jr.

9. In which year did Gandhi receive Time magazine's Person of the Year award?

Ans: 1930 (published Jan 1931), for the Dandi March

10. Who was Gandhi's "political guru"?

Ans: Gopal Krishna Gokhale

11. Who gave Rabindranath Tagore the title "Gurudev"?

Ans: Mahatma Gandhi

12. Who gave Gandhi the title "Mahatma"?

Ans: Rabindranath Tagore, 1915

13. Who gave Gandhi the title "Father of the Nation"?

Ans: Subhas Chandra Bose, 1944

14. When did Gandhi withdraw the Non-Cooperation Movement?

Ans: 12 February 1922

15. Which incident led to the withdrawal of the Non-Cooperation Movement?

Ans: Chauri Chaura incident, Feb 1922

16. Who compared the Dandi March to Napoleon's Paris-to-Elba journey?

Ans: Subhas Chandra Bose

17. When did Gandhi establish the Charkha Sangh?

Ans: 1925

18. What is the correct chronological order: Champaran, Kheda, Ahmedabad, Non-Cooperation?

Ans: Champaran (1917) → Ahmedabad (1918) → Kheda (1918) → Non-Cooperation (1920)

19. Which movement is NOT associated with Gandhi?

Ans: Swadeshi Movement (1905) — Gandhi was in South Africa then

20. Which jail did Gandhi refer to as a "temple"?

Ans: Yerwada Jail

21. Who said "The light has gone out of our lives" on Gandhi's death?

Ans: Jawaharlal Nehru

22. When did Gandhi die, and how many bullets were fired?

Ans: 30 January 1948; 3 rounds

23. What were Gandhi's last words?

Ans: "He Ram"

24. When did Gandhi deliver his first public speech in India?

Ans: 1916, at the BHU opening

25. Who drew attention to the exploitation of Champaran's indigo farmers?

Ans: Rajkumar Shukla

26. What was the Tinkathia system?

Ans: Forced indigo cultivation on 3/20th of land

27. How is Gandhi's birth anniversary (2 October) celebrated internationally?

Ans: International Day of Non-Violence

28. Who gave the slogan "Do or Die"?

Ans: Mahatma Gandhi, 1942

29. At which station was Gandhi thrown off a train in South Africa?

Ans: Pietermaritzburg

30. Whose writings greatly influenced Gandhi?

Ans: Leo Tolstoy

31. Who considered khadi a symbol of economic independence?

Ans: Mahatma Gandhi

32. When did Gandhi first practise Satyagraha in South Africa (leading to jail in 1908)?

Ans: 1906

33. Who presided over the All India Khilafat Committee session in Delhi, 1919?

Ans: Mahatma Gandhi

34. Who established the Phoenix Settlement in South Africa?

Ans: Mahatma Gandhi, 1904

35. When was the Quit India Movement launched?

Ans: 1942

36. How many years did Gandhi stay in South Africa?

Ans: 21 years

37. In which movement did Gandhi first use hunger strike as a weapon?

Ans: Ahmedabad Mill Strike, 1918

38. Where did Gandhi adopt the principle of "Seva Dharma"?

Ans: South Africa, during the Boer War

39. In which Congress session did Gandhi first participate?

Ans: 1901, Calcutta session (headed by Dinshaw Edulji Wacha)

40. When did Gandhi establish the Natal Congress?

Ans: 1894

41. Where did Gandhi disembark in India upon his return from South Africa?

Ans: Bombay, Apollo Bunder

42. When was Gandhi given the title "Kaiser-i-Hind"?

Ans: 1915

43. When did Gandhi establish the All India Harijan Sevak Sangh?

Ans: 1932

44. With whom did Gandhi sign the Yerwada/Poona Pact?

Ans: Dr. B.R. Ambedkar

45. Who wrote "India of My Dreams"?

Ans: Mahatma Gandhi

46. Who wrote "Hind Swaraj", and when?

Ans: Mahatma Gandhi, 1909

47. Which newspaper did Gandhi publish in South Africa?

Ans: Indian Opinion

48. Who gave Gandhi the title "One-Man Boundary Force"?

Ans: Lord Mountbatten

49. Who called Gandhi a "half-naked fakir"?

Ans: Winston Churchill

50. When did Gandhi launch the Kheda Satyagraha?

Ans: 1918

51. When did Gandhi start the Civil Disobedience Movement?

Ans: 1930

52. Who were the first and second satyagrahis of the Individual Satyagraha?

Ans: Vinoba Bhave (first), Jawaharlal Nehru (second)

53. Who wrote "The Life of Mahatma Gandhi"?

Ans: Louis Fischer

54. In which Round Table Conference did Gandhi participate?

Ans: The Second Round Table Conference, 1931

55. What did Gandhi call the 1942 Cripps Mission?

Ans: "A post-dated cheque"

56. Who compiled "Gandhi on Non-Violence"?

Ans: Thomas Merton

57. Who wrote "Being Gandhi"?

Ans: Paro Anand

58. In which language was "My Experiments with Truth" originally written?

Ans: Gujarati (1928), translated to English by Mahadev Desai

59. When was the "Mahatma" title first added to Gandhi's name?

Ans: 1915 (met Tagore), popularised by 1917

60. When did Gandhi first go to South Africa?

Ans: 1893

61. Who went to meet Gandhi in South Africa?

Ans: Gopal Krishna Gokhale

62. When did Gandhi go to London to study law?

Ans: 1888

63. Who was the first Indian to receive the Bharat Ratna posthumously?

Ans: Lal Bahadur Shastri, 1966 (not Gandhi)

21 Extra Practice (Beyond the Video)

E1. What was the exact name of the book Subhas Chandra Bose wrote as a counterpart to "India of My Dreams"?

Ans: A work themed on Indian youth's vision for India's future

E2. Which act of the Chauri Chaura incident specifically upset Gandhi?

Ans: A mob set fire to a police station, killing about 22 policemen

E3. Who was the chairman of the 1942 Cripps Mission?

Ans: Sir Stafford Cripps

E4. Besides Gujarati and English, name another book central to Gandhi's philosophy of trusteeship.

Ans: Ruskin's "Unto This Last" inspired Gandhi's concept of trusteeship and simple living

E5. What was the outcome of Gandhi's dispute with Ambedkar at the Second Round Table Conference?

Ans: It led to the Communal Award (1932) and, subsequently, the Poona Pact, replacing separate electorates with reserved seats

22 Bonus — Standard-Syllabus Points (Not in the Video)

Commonly tested alongside "Mahatma Gandhi" but not explicitly covered in the lecture. Verified against standard references.

- **Champaran Satyagraha's legal outcome:** Led to the Champaran Agrarian Act, 1917, which abolished the Tinkathia system — the direct policy result of Gandhi's first Indian movement.
- **Sabarmati Ashram & Satyagraha Ashram:** Founded by Gandhi in 1917, on the banks of the Sabarmati river in Ahmedabad — the starting point of the Dandi March in 1930.
- **Nai Talim (Basic Education):** Gandhi's educational philosophy, emphasising learning through handicrafts and self-reliance — a useful companion fact to his broader Khadi/Swadeshi economic philosophy.
- **Gandhi Smriti, Delhi:** The site (formerly Birla House) where Gandhi was assassinated on 30 January 1948, now a memorial museum.

Cross-check all dates with your NCERT Class VIII "Our Past III" and Class XII "Themes in Indian History-III" for the standard textbook framing.

This is **Part 7 of an 8-part series** covering the full lecture. The Indian National Movement and Miscellaneous topics are covered next in **Part 8**, the final part.